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A Christian School and Home

J. E. FULTON

THERE are now nearly 30,000 of our Seventh-day Adventist young people in our schools in all parts of the world. Seventh-day Adventists are very much in earnest over the question of a suitable Christian education. Millions of dollars have been invested in properties and equipment, and new educational projects are constantly being carried forward with a rapidly advancing work. Seventh-day Adventists are in earnest over this subject knowing that the hope of the denomination is to be found in the proper education for service of the young people. A captain in giving orders on the wreck of his vessel called out as passengers were making for the life boats, "The children first." And so in this time of crisis and danger to old and young our first thought should be for the children and youth.

"Shall the youth be left to drift hither and thither, to become discouraged, and to fall into temptations that are everywhere lurking to catch unwary feet? The work that lies nearest to our church members is to become interested in our youth, with kindness, patience, and tenderness, giving them line upon line, precept upon precept. O, where are the fathers and mothers in Israel? There ought to be a large number who, as stewards of the grace of Christ, would feel not merely a casual interest, but a special interest in the young. There ought to be many whose hearts are touched by the pitiable situation in which our youth are placed, who realize that Satan is working by every conceivable device to draw them into his net. God requires the church to arouse from its lethargy, and see what manner of service is demanded in this time of peril.

"True education is missionary training. Every son and daughter of God is called to be a missionary; we are called to the service of God and our fellow-men; and to fit us for this service should be the object of our education.

"This object should ever be kept in view by Christian parents and teachers. We know not in what line our children may serve. They may spend their lives within the circle of the home; they may engage in life's common vocations, or go as teachers of the gospel; but all are alike called to be missionaries for God, ministers of mercy to the world.

What Do YOU Say?

SOMEBODY said that it couldn't be done,
But he with a chuckle replied
That "Maybe it couldn't," but he would be one
Who wouldn't say so till he tried.
So he buckled right in, with the trace of a grin
On his face. If he worried he hid it.
He started to sing as he tackled the thing
That couldn't be done—and he did it!

There are thousands who tell you it cannot be done,
There are thousands who prophesy failure;
There are thousands to point out to you one by one
The dangers that wait to assail you.
But just buckle right in with a bit of a grin,
Then take off your coat and go to it.
Just start in to sing as you tackle the thing
That "cannot be done"—and you'll do it!

—*Selected.*

"The children and youth, with their fresh talent, energy, and courage, their quick susceptibilities, are loved of God, and He desires to bring them into harmony with divine agencies. They are to obtain an education that will help them stand by the side of Christ in unselfish service.

"Our children stand, as it were, at the parting of the ways. On every hand the world's enticements to self-seeking and self-indulgence call them away from the path cast up for the ransomed of the Lord. Whether their lives shall be a blessing or a curse depends upon the choice they make. Overflowing with energy, eager to test their untried capabilities, they must find some outlet for their superabounding life. Active they will be for good or for evil."

In India we now have a small but growing constituency of Anglo-Indian brethren and sisters whose children need the advantages of a good school and home where these young people may have opportunities for physical, mental and spiritual culture. The members of the Executive Board are bending every energy to provide all this in the re-establishment of the English school at Vincent Hill, Mussoorie. The advantages of Mussoorie as an educational centre have long been established. Its beautiful surroundings, and its invigorating climate are well known. And so after much thought and prayer it has been decided to go forward with the purchase of land, and with the erection of suitable buildings in a part of Mussoorie quite removed from bazars and the excitement of the town. In doing this we feel sure we are in harmony with the instruction the Lord has given about the establishment of our schools away from the busy centres and in healthful locations where the youth can come close to nature.

It is not enough that our children receive an education in the popular sense. This is right enough for people of the world. But God has revealed to us a wonderful truth and that message makes plain the nearness of the end. We have therefore a great work of preparation for ourselves and our children. Our children should receive a good education, but in addition to what is understood by that term, they must be instructed in present truth and prepared for a part, should the Lord tarry, in the proclamation of this closing gospel message. It is therefore evident that an educational system, peculiar to our times and to the finishing of our work, is demanded for Seventh-day Adventists. India is to be no exception, and we are sure the time has come when we can say in confidence, "The God of heaven, He will prosper us; therefore we His servants will arise and build."

The Lord Will Influence Wealthy Men to Give.

G. F. ENOCH.

IN Isaiah 60:11 (margin) we have the direct promise that the wealth of the Gentiles will come to the Church in the last days when darkness covers the earth. I believe that in our present campaign all our people should go forth in faith claiming these promises and see their fulfillment. We have tried to give our people the very best sort of compaign material that we can produce. We have a plea that none can deny. The entire European community knows that our boys and girls of the coming generation will have a much different situation to face than we have had to face. It is the opportune moment to raise money for an English school.

I feel that the attitude of most wealthy men will be much like that expressed by the Mussoorie correspondent of the *Indian Daily Telegraph*. He said, "Some parents will doubtless shy at the peculiar tenets of the Seventh-day Adventist—but they are good Christians—so whether they elect Saturday to be their Sabbath instead of Sunday, what on earth does it matter?"

Let us then not be afraid of approaching this class of men for fear they will not want to help an Adventist institution. We can appeal for the laying aside of all religious or other prejudices for the sake of the boys and girls of the rising generation. In the last book written by Sister White she spoke some encouraging words along this line, as follows:

"Nehemiah did not depend on uncertainty. The means that he lacked he solicited from those who were able to bestow. And the Lord was willing to move upon the hearts of those in posession of His goods, in behalf of the cause of truth. Those who labour for Him are to avail themselves of the help that He prompts men to give. These gifts may open ways by which the light of truth shall go to many benighted lands. The donors may have no faith in Christ, no acquaintence with His word; but their gifts are not on this account to be refused." —"*Prophets and Kings*," *p. 634.*

An Open Letter from the Executive Board

To Our Fellow-Workers and Fellow-Believers in Southern Asia.

Dear Brethren and Sisters:

For some time we have been hoping to see our English school established on a better basis. In this we have had three main objects in view.

(1.) To work for the enlisting of the efforts of all our young people as they grow up among us in the great work of giving to the world the message we love. This would require

(2.) That we should provide a strong faculty in our English school so as to make it possible to hold and train the young people long enough to enable them to take their places in the Lord's work on the completion of their courses of study, and

(3.) That we should provide building and equipment that would as far as possible facilitate the work of the school in the training of the students.

Our English Churches to Supply Workers.

In regard to the first consideration, that we ought to expect our English churches to be recruiting grounds from which young people and others may be drawn to be workers in the cause, we wish to call attention to the fact that already many valuable helpers in the Mission work have come from among the members of these churches. Some of these workers are carrying responsibilities in our treatment rooms, others in the school work, one is a colporteur in Burma, another a zenana worker in Lucknow, and still another is superintendent of our Malayalam Mission. These have all accepted the truth in connection with our English efforts. Our responsible office workers also have come almost entirely from our English churches, as far instance the General Conference sub-treasurer, the secretary-treasurer of the South India Union Mission, and the treasurer of the North-east India Union Mission.

Besides these workers, most of whom have laboured in the cause a good many years, no less than nineteen members of our English churches, mostly young people, have, during the past two years or so, accepted appointments in our work in its various branches. It has been, and is the considered policy of our Foreign Mission Board, and of the Board directing the work in this country, to give every possible opportunity to consecrated young people and other members of our churches to find places of usefulness in the Lord's work. It is with this end in view that we are advocating the strengthening of our school work, for we believe that if our English school can be made all that it should be, we shall see a much larger number of our young people converted to God and devoting their lives to his cause.

Opportunities Before Our Children.

If we can lead our children to consecrate their lives to the service of Christ this will save them as well as advance the gospel work. So we urge for the children's sake that we set before them this noblest and highest of all life-purposes.

The world's history will soon close. In the brief time that remains the younger members of the Lord's household may act a glorious part in the closing work, if we will have faith for them, and will encourage them in it. The following passage from the Testimonies should inspire our hearts with hope for our children:

"God's purpose for the children growing up beside our hearths is wider, deeper, higher, than our restricted vision has comprehended. From the humblest lot those whom He has seen faithful have in time past been called to witness for Him in the world's highest places. And many a lad of today, growing up as did Daniel in his Judean home, studying God's word and His works, and learning the lessons of faithful service, will yet stand in legislative assemblies, in halls of justice, or in royal courts, as a witness for the King of Kings. Multitudes will be called to a wider ministry."—"*Education*," p. 262.

In a recent letter, Brother Dudley Meyers, now a missionary to the Indian colonists in Fiji, writes as follows:

"We often think of India and its people. The scenes around Lucknow are connected with my boyhood days. I spent two years in the printing office when it was first moved from Calcutta to Lucknow, and this was a help to me in getting the language, which has been of so much use to me in my work here. We thank God for the way he has blessed our efforts for these people here in Suva."

How many more of our lads may yet in God's providence look back from lives of usefulness to "boyhood days," spent in our institutions in this country? A great many, beyond doubt, if we will have larger faith for them.

Sister Meyers encouraged her sons to give their lives to God's work, and the Lord has blessed her efforts. One son (Dudley) is now

a missionary in Fiji. Cecil K. Meyers after bearing heavy responsibilities in Australia as vice-president and afterwards as president of that union conference, has now been appointed an assistant-secretary of the General Conference. Harold, the youngest son, is in the ministry in Tasmania. No greater satisfaction can some to true Christian parents than to see their children become faithful labourers in the cause of Christ, in whatsoever capacity.

Varied Lines of Usefulness.

Some may question the practicability of so many young people being employed in connection with the Mission work. The possibilities are far greater probably than any of us realize. Not all could be employed in the ministry, certainly, for the Lord has not called all to the ministry. But there are many of our lines of work that are self-supporting, and that call for varied capabilities and talents. There must be fully ten thousand persons employed in our work throughout the world, and of these the great majority are employed in lines of effort other than the ministry. There are nurses, treatment room workers, doctors, health food manufacturers, vegetarian restaurant workers, printers, bookbinders, editors, proof-readers, colporteurs, tract society workers, treasurers, secretaries, accountants, stenographers, teachers, etc.

In Australasia there are about two hundred of our people employed in connection with the health food work alone. Such lines of work enable our people to earn their living while exerting a missionary influence, carrying on an enterprise that brings before the people certain phases of the truth.

It is true that we have not as yet seen a very large development of these self-supporting lines of work in India. But still a good beginning has been made, and there are abundant opportunities for expansion. The rapidity of the expansion will depend largely, however, upon the supply of earnest and capable young people that may be available, and to keep up the supply of young people imbued with the spirit and principles of the message, it is absolutely essential that we have a strong school led by a faculty of teachers who are themselves unreservedly devoted to the work, and who have the necessary technical training. If in such a school our students could study up to the senior Cambridge standard, we would then be able to use many of them in some of the various lines of work mentioned above, and in these lines of work some would gain an experience that would lead on to their being called to the work of the ministry.

It is interesting to note that of those who have recently accepted appointments in Mission work in India three are connected with the evangelical work, two with the health food work, four are in office work, six in treatment room work, and four in the school work.

For those who wish to complete the ministerial or college course in England or America, or to take the medical course at our Loma Linda College, the ten-standard course in our school in India will be approximately equal to the academic course in America, thus enabling our students who might be able to go there, to complete the college course in another four years, or the medical course in another six years.

The Faculty.

The General Conference has sent us Prof. Thos. D. Rowe, B. A., of Canada, to take the principalship of the school and to lead out in its re-establishment. Brother Rowe had charge of the Battleford Academy, Canada, up to the time of his departure for India, and has had twenty-one years experience in our school work. The brethren have selected him because of his experience and success as a school administrator. We believe that Brother Rowe is just the man we need as a leader for our school work. Besides taking the principalship, he will lead out in the Bible instruction.

Brother L. A. Semmens is to be preceptor in addition to the duties he will carry as a teacher. We believe Brother Semmens will be a great help to the young people who will be under his care. He is full of interest in their welfare, and very enthusiastic as to their possibilities. These qualities go a long way in helping a teacher to win the confidence of his students. We believe that Brother Semmens' work as preceptor will add greatly to the strength of the school.

Sister O'Connor who has for so long done efficient and faithful work in the school will continue to be a member of the faculty. This year several other members also have been added to the working force of the institution.

We feel that a really strong and efficient faculty has been secured, and this gives us confidence in pressing on with the plans for the provision of better facilities.

Vincent Hill School Site.

We have been fortunate in securing a very desirable property in the Vincent Hill Road, Mussoorie, that we believe will make a splendid site for the new buildings. All our people who have seen the property have expressed themselves as delighted with it. There are about forty-six acres in the estate, in which are found a number of fine building sites, and room also for the development of quite extensive spaces for gardens and exercise grounds. We doubt if any school in Mussoorie will be better provided for in these respects. After we had agreed with the owner for the purchase of the property, we heard that others, who were looking for a site for a school of a similar nature, were willing to give ten thousand rupees more for it than we were paying. We believe the Lord has led us in the purchase of this estate, and that His providence has kept the way open so that we could secure it.

The new site is about two miles from the library (which is situated on The Mall, and

generally regarded as quite a central place in Mussoorie) and is approached by good rickshaw road of an easy gradient. Municipal electric light and water services are available. One very satisfatory feature in connenction with the new location is that it is very select. There will be no bazaars nor crowded quarters between the school and the town; but only a few bungalows of a good class. The building sites and grounds on the new estate have the benefit of the sunshine practically all day and command a magnificent view of the Doon. It is possible that the motor road that is being constructed from Rajpur to Mussoorie will skirt the lower levels of the school land.

Cost of Development.

The price paid for the land was Rs. 20,000 and it is estimated that it will take another Rs. 15,000 to put in roads, prepare building sites, and develop the possibilities of the estate in the way of making gardens, walks, and exercise grounds. This will make a cost of Rs. 35,000 apart from the cost of any buildings that may be erected.

After careful study of the whole situation, and the inspection of other school properties that were being offered for sale, our Committee decided that our money would be best spent by putting it into an undeveloped estate. Properties already developed are very expensive, and the buildings are not likely to be just what we need. Even though it will be necessary for us to spend Rs. 35,000 on the land and its development, we find that in the end the school will not cost us any more than it would if we bought a property already developed, and adapted it to the needs of our school. With a new property we have the advantage of being able to plan for the buildings exactly as the needs of our work demand.

The Proposed Buildings.

We expect that the school will eventually require three main buildings,—a school hall, a boys' hall, and a girls' hall, with entirely separate grounds for boys and girls. It is suggested that for the present we erect one building that will provide sufficient accomodation to meet most of the present needs, with the understanding that it will eventually become the girls' hall when the attendance increases sufficiently to require the completion of the other buildings for the boys' hall, class-rooms, etc. The plans for the first building have been drawn up with the idea of providing accomodation that will be ideal for a girls' hall when the time comes that the whole building will be needed for that purpose, and yet that will mean while be quite convenient also for the class-rooms, dining hall, assembly room, teachers' quarters, and other school purposes. Only a portion of the boys' hall will be erected for the present, and the erection of the school hall will not be undertaken until the growth of the school demands it.

The building plans that have been approved by the Executive Board have been explained in a previous issue of the *Tidings*, from which our people have learned more in detail about the proposed arrangements. It will be sufficient to state here that it is the intention of the brethren to provide a really satisfactory and convenient school home such as will be a permanent boon to the work of the institution. It is intended for instance to have a fireproof staircase and spacious fireproof passages throughout, that will make it possible for a hundred persons to vacate the building inside of three minutes. Ample bath-room and lavatory accomodation is planned for, including full baths, fixed washbowls, hot and cold water service, and water system sanitation, connected with a septic tank. The sleeping, living, and study rooms will all be large, light and airy. Everything is planned for in fact that will go to make the place a safe and healthful home for our children in which they can have the best educational facilities and be surrounded with refining influences.

The Cost of Building.

In order to erect the buildings now planned for and to equip and furnish them, it is estimated that Rs. 90,000 will be needed. This means that a total of approximately one lakh and a quarter of rupees will be needed to cover the cost of the land and its development and for the erection and equipment of the first buildings. It is estimated that the completion of the entire scheme will involve an expenditure of about two and a half lakhs of rupees; but this will of course be spread over a number of years as the needs of the cause may demand. This may at first thought seem to be an ambitious plan, calling for very heavy expense; but it has been the experience of our brethren in other lands that we are bound to make liberal provision for our educational institutions, and that such a course is the only truly economical one. This will be a small investment compared with the large sums other bodies are expending on their school work in this country. With such a message as we have, and with a great work before us yet to be accomplished, we feel that the proposals now being set before our brethren are fully warranted.

Before bringing this matter before our churches, the Committee responsible for the oversight of the work in India has exhausted its available resources in the endeavour to bring within the range of practicability a plan such as is now outlined. In our 1918 budget the General Conference allowed us Rs. 20,000 for the re-establishment of the English School. To this the India Union Mission Committee added Rs. 20,000, the accumulated income of the India Financial Association since its incorporation. The India Financial Association receives all rents paid on mission-owned properties, and it was from that source that in the course of a number of years the sum mentioned was accumulated. Another Rs. 10,000 was voted to the school enterprise, the savings of surplus amounts left over from various budgets. In voting these two large amounts the India Union Mission exhausted the resources at its command for an enter-

prise of this kind. The fact that the Union Mission voted all its available reserve funds to be used for the re-establishment of this school, may be taken as an indication of the great importance that attaches to the enterprise in the minds of the leading brethren, especially when it is considered that there are many other calls for funds and pressing needs in connection with our rapidly expanding work.

The school building fund has been further augmented by the sale of the Annfield property for Rs. 19,000.

The following is a summary of the funds available above mentioned:

General Conference 1918 Appropriation	Rs. 20,000
India Financial Association Accumulated Income	20,000
Budget Surplus Accumulations	10 000
Sale of Annfield property	19,000
TOTAL	69,000

All the amounts spoken of above may be said to have come to us in in one way or another from the brethren in America.

If we are to increase this amount (Rs. 69,000) without delay to Rs. 125,000, that will mean that we will need to raise immediately about Rs. 56,000 within India and Burma. This will cover the carrying out of the plans now approved. The financial campaign will be continued until the larger amount needed to complete the scheme has been received, thus providing for a larger body of students.

At the biennial session of the India Union Mission held at Calcutta early in January, 1917, when it was decided to undertake the re-establishment of the English school, those present at the conference pledged liberally to the building fund, with the result that a total of about Rs. 7,000 was reached. Members of the Calcutta and Lucknow churches have more recently pledged more than another Rs. 7,000, thus making a total of Rs. 14,000. This represents the first instalment on the Rs. 56,000 we hope to raise immediately within our own territory.

This statement is made by the Executive Board in order to give full information to all our workers and believers, including the isolated Sabbath-keepers, and to appeal to all to support this enterprise with their sympathetic interest and earnest prayers, and by a liberal offering such as the Lord may place it within the power of each one to give. This school enterprise is the biggest thing we have yet undertaken in India and is worthy of our supreme effort. If we will all give unselfish and enthusiastic co-operation the task will soon be accomplished, and the blessed result will surely be the salvation of an army of our young people, and a great strengthening of our work in this country.

A Closing Appeal.

The Executive Board has invited Pastor G. F. Enoch to lead out in bringing before our people in India the needs of this school enterprise, and in raising the necessary funds. Brother Enoch will be able to keep our people informed as to the progress made in raising the amount needed, as the total swells from the point that has been reached as we issue this statement. The funds pledged at present total approximately Rs. 83,000, made up of the General Conference and India Union Mission appropriations (Rs. 69,000) and the subscriptions from within India to date (Rs. 14,000). This leaves a balance of Rs. 42,000 yet to be raised immediately within our Mission territory in Southern Asia, and a larger balance later. This amount we hope will be raised by the donations of our own people, and funds our members may be able to secure from those outside our ranks who are interested in helping educational work of this kind. A special number of the *Tidings* has been issued for use in collecting funds for the school from the general public. The brethren are also importing 5,000 copies of Brother C. B. Haynes' new book, "What is Coming?" with the idea that many of our people will be able to earn money for the school fund by engaging in its sale. This book is put out in very attractive style; is proving to be a very ready seller, and will accomplish a great deal in disseminating a knowledge of the present truth.

As Pastor Enoch and others who may be associated with him bring this matter before our believers and explain the various plans by which it is hoped we will be able to raise the balance of the funds needed for the school, we bespeak for them a sympathetic hearing and the enthusiastic co-operation of all our workers and believers.

As we seek to carry out what is by far the largest enterprise we have yet undertaken in India we ask for the earnest prayers of all God's people. Let us have faith in God. He is able and will give us success in extending His work to a degree that may to human eyes appear impossible.

"Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that worketh in us, unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages world without end, Amen."

[*Signed*] J. E. FULTON,
W. W. FLETCHER,
A. H. WILLIAMS,
H. C. MENKEL,
I. F. BLUE,
S. A. WELLMAN,
G. G. LOWRY,
L. C. SHEPARD.

THE English edition of "The Future of the World" should be ready for the field within a fortnight. The Urdu edition will follow shortly, while the edition in Gujarati will be completed soon afterwards. The selling price for all editions, with the exception of the Burmese, is eight annas, with a fifty per cent. discount to our workers. The publishing house is anticipating a large sale for this booklet in the various vernaculars as well as in the English.

Some School Campaigns in America

G. F. ENOCH

It was the privilege of the writer to have a share in several campaigns for raising money for our schools in America during my recent period of furlough. Large sums of money were raised in remarkably short time, because the conviction settled down over our people generally that time is short, and they must give their children such a training as would safeguard them for the cause.

We adopted the plan there of raising the money in one hundred dollar gift-shares. It is really an investment that will pay us large dividends. The world buys shares for financial profit. But there is a loss or gain that ledger balances can never show. We believe as a people that this present world is about to pass away to be succeeded by the better age that is to come. It does not matter so much to us whether we lay up little or more here, for it is all about to perish in the last final destruction. But it does matter whether we have a bank account in heaven or not. We give in another article some wise words on this matter written by Sister White many years ago. This is not mere sentiment or fancy, but in full harmony with what our Saviour Himself said in His exhortation to us to lay up treasure in heaven. We are to make to ourselves friends by means of this mammon which the world uses for unrighteous purposes, so that when all things earthly fail, as they must fail, these friends will receive us with our children into the eternal habitations.

With such thoughts as these our people in America, in campaigns with which the writer was connected, gave about two and one-half lakhs of rupees to Washington Missionary College at Washington, D. C., more than a lakh and a half to the Walla Walla College, in the State of Washington, (the writer's Alma Mater) a little more than a lakh to found the Western Washington Academy at Auburn, also founding the Southern Oregon Academy at Southern Oregon, besides giving considerable sums for strengthening the schools at Mt. Vernon, Ohio, South Lancaster, Massachusetts, and Ooltewah, Tennessee.

The Lord was with us in all these campaigns in a very striking way. I feel sure that He will give us the same guidance and success here in India. We have decided to raise this money in India in gift-shares of one hundred rupees each. It will require only 1500 of these shares to make our lakh and a half. While many of our people will not be able to give large sums, yet we can gather from others, which will amount to the same thing, if the money reaches the treasury. I will begin the campaign in Simla in October, and we hope then to keep the ball rolling until every city and town in India and Burma is reached where there are Europeans or Anglo-Indians.

We must do this as quickly as possible, and everybody must take hold and lift. For the sake of our own boys and girls let none ask to be excused. We have sent out campaign material to many of our people. It will be as well in the larger churches to await our arrival before beginning the campaign. Those away from churches who have not received campaign literature should apply to the office for the same. In Nehemiah's day it was said, "So all the wall was joined together unto the half thereof; *for the people had a mind to work*." Neh. 4:6.

How We Divide the Responsibility

G. F. ENOCH.

In considering the abilities of the various churches, and the wealth and numbers of the European communities, it has been suggested that we raise the lakh and a half of rupees for our Vincent Hill School as follows:

Calcutta	500 Shares, or	Rs	50 000
Bombay	350 ,, ,,		35 000
Burma	200 ,, ,,		20 000
United Provinces,	150 ,, ,,		15 000
Punjab	150 ,, ,,		15,000
S. India	150 ,, ,,		15,000
Total	1500 Shares, or	Rs.	1,50,000

I believe that we can and that we will do it. What is your response?

"God has two dwellings: one in heaven and the other in a meek and thankful heart."

In Touch With the Source of All Power

G. F. ENOCH.

"It is in working actively to supply the necessities of the cause of God that we bring our souls in touch with the Source of all power."—"*Testimonies for the Church*," *Vol. VI. p.* 27.

How we long to have this vital touch! But it will never come to us through inaction. The law of action is the law of life. This is just as true in the spiritual world as in the physical. It is not easy to put forth effort. We naturally shrink from it. But happiness is found only along the busy paths.

So there are many and vital needs of the cause of God. They must be supplied. We are here to supply them. As we put forth consecrated effort God fills us with His mighty power, and the life-giving current fills our whole being.

The establishment of Vincent Hill School is one of the most pressing necessities of the cause of God here in India at the present time. This necessity must be supplied. We can go out and earn money and ask others to give money that this necessity may be supplied. As we do this the life-giving power of God will flow into our lives. Let us then consecrate our all to this end.

I well remember an experience in a similar campaign in America. A poor cobbler brother, in a small Pennsylvania town, desired very much to have some share in establishing these training colleges. But he had a large family and it was a struggle to keep the wolf from the door. In spite of all this he promised to provide one full share towards our fund. The conference president told me to put it in the doubtful list, as it was likely never to be paid. But at the camp-meeting next year we still had a balance to make up. This brother was one of the first on his feet and subscribed two shares. I asked him how he could do so. He replied, "When you were at our church last year I wanted to help, and promised the Lord that if He would help me I would give that share. Well from that time my customers seemed to multiply; I have had to sit up nights to keep up with the work the Lord has sent to me; I have found it pays to be in partnership with the Lord, and I want to continue it, so I will take two shares this time."

And so brethren and sisters, let us form a partnership with the Lord in this matter. It will bring us in touch with the Source of all power.

Rangoon English Effort.

G. A. HAMILTON

WE baptized yesterday a native of Ceylon who gives promise of proving a faithful Christian. A doctor by the name of——— told me at the service last night that he was fully convinced that we have the truth, and is arranging his work so that he can keep the Sabbath. He has a practice here. He is a very nice man.

The wife of a man who is planning to keep the Sabbath has begun to obey, so we learned last night. We had a good attendance at the meeting, of a good class of people.

A young lady who was prevented from joining us some time ago by her parents, has since married, and both she and her husband are now much interested, and are attending almost every meeting.

Mrs. Hamilton has got the young people's society organized and at work. The older ones are taking hold, and the outlook is the most hopeful we have seen for some time, though there is much room for improvement.

Brother Hare is here, and is a fine helper in the meetings. We are also very grateful for Dr. Tornblad's help.

A Letter from Sister Chilton.

SISTER VERA CHILTON is spending her furlough at Wahroonga, New South Wales, where the headquarters of the Australasian Union Conference is located. Sister Chilton writes of her impressions of Australia and of our work there as follows:

"Australia is certainly a bright, vigourous, cheerful country, and Wahroonga everything that was said of it in the way of peace and quiet; but my heart is in India, and I am eagerly looking forward to coming back again. It seems so prosaic and commonplace here, without the Indian people. To help me out, Mr. and Mrs. Carswell are going to take me out to see a colony of (Australian) aborigines, and I look forward to it more than anything else.

"This (Wahroonga) is quite a Seventh-day Adventist colony. It is quite new for me to see

so many of our people in one place. I am favourably impressed with the sanitarium and the church and offices. The location is most beautiful."

Australia is a country where house servants are becoming almost unknown, except in the homes of the wealthier class. The great majority of Australian women have to do their own house cleaning, cooking, washing, etc. Of this Sister Chilton says:

"I cannot say I enjoy the Australian style of living. The whole day seems wasted and interrupted. This perpetual cleaning and dusting and cooking and eating and washing and ironing gets on my nerves, and there seems no solid time to sit down and collect one's thoughts, to write, or be intelligent."

The Executive Board has asked Sister Chilton to do some writing during her furlough, including the preparation of a book on the life in the Zenanas of India, for publication in America, to stimulate interest in Indian missions. Sister Chilton continues:

"I have not begun on my books yet. Every particle of spare time has been given to missionary letters, and writing to the homes of my women in Lucknow, which is quite a big task. My head is not strong enough to work at night, which is the quietest time. I will do my best, however, about the books. I know you do not wish me to get too anxious about them and as I gradually grow accustomed to the new style of life, I shall be able to get more quiet time for my writing."

A'chu and Other Stories.

In a recent issue of the *Tidings* we mentioned in connection with the Young People's Reading Courses the name of the volume that heads this article. It is listed for the Junior Reading Course of the Missionary Volunteers. Having since given the volume a careful reading, we can thoroughly recommend it to our young people, and we would suggest that in so far as possible they obtain this volume at least of those listed, and read it. The story of the Chang family; the short sketches of Chinese life; the records of visits among the Chinese people, and accounts of their customs and ways, all are well told, and are rich in information regarding China and its interesting people. It will find a warm spot in the hearts of parents as well as children, and while reading it yourself it might be well to read it to the younger members of the family. We have used this plan and found our small boy in wrapt attention following the entire story.

A'chu and Other Stories may be ordered through the Seventh-day Adventist Publishing House, 17 Abbott Road, Lucknow, and will be furnished for Rs. 4-15-0. As the orders will have to be sent to the publishers in America this should be allowed for in anticipating the receipt of the book. S. A. WELLMAN.

Test Yourself.

You should be able to walk ten miles with ease. Are you? The only way to find out is to try it—not all at once, but see if you can work up to it.

You should be able to enter into conversation with a stranger of your own sex (under suitable circumstances), courteously, and profitably. Are you? Try it.

You should be able to entertain guests at your table so that all present will enjoy themselves. Are you? Try it.

You should be able to read a volume of history, biography, essays, or poetry with as much real enjoyment as a novel. Are you? Try it.

You should be able to listen to a sermon or a lecture on a substantial subject, and carry away the main points so that you can repeat them afterward. Are you? Try it.

You should have mental resources so that, if left alone for a day, you will be good company for yourself, and be happy all day long. Have you? Try it.

You should have grace enough to submit to insult or injustice patiently, put up with crossness serenely, and answer anger with love. Have you? Try it.

You should be able to read your Bible by the book instead of by the chapter or verse, and delight in the reading. Are you? Try it.

You should be able to pray for at least fifteen minutes by the watch (mechanical? —there is no other way of getting at the facts)—and still have much left that you want to talk over with your heavenly Father. Are you? Try it.

These all indicate fundamentals of the physical, social, mental and spiritual life. Have you ever tested yourself in regard to them, strictly and honestly? If not, do it. I dare you!—*Amos R. Wells, in the Christian Endeavour World.*

PASTOR AND SISTER W. W. FLETCHER, together with their infant son, have recently been spending several days in Mussoorie where Sister Fletcher received treatments for a very painful attack of muscular rheumatism, affecting the neck. We are pleased to report at this writing that the treatments have been quite successful, and that Sister Fletcher is much better.

THE "BIG WEEK"

About five years ago when Brother C. E. Weeks was on furlough in America he was the field secretary of the Northern Union Conference. At that time he originated the idea of a "Big Week" in the literature work. During that time every worker in the conference went into the field to sell books. The colporteurs made a special effort to make a good record, and the other workers, from the conference president down, did the same thing. The week was so successful and such a source of strength to the literature work that the next year a "Big Week" was appointed for the whole country. At the last Spring Council of the General Conference it was recommended that there be a "Big Week" for the world.

In harmony with that recommendation the following action was taken at the recent meeting of the Executive Board held in Lucknow:

"VOTED, That our "Big Week" in the literature work be timed for January 16-22, 1921, and that we put forth an earnest effort to enlist the co-operation of the entire body of our foreign, Indian, and Burmese workers and students in the Southern Asia Division during that week in the sale of our literature in all languages."

The idea of a "Big Week" is something that is new in India. In fact in years past it has been a real problem to get the literature circulated at all in India. The idea seems to be prevalent among Indians that to sell books or papers is small business and below the dignity of decent people. We must do something to break down this prejudice.

One way that we can do this is for each one of us to go out during that week and engage in the selling of our books and magazines. Let every superintendent, station worker, evangelist, teacher and Bible worker go out with the colporteurs during that week. By our example, better than by our words, can we show the dignity of this work.

By the time that the "Big Week" rolls around we expect to have some new and up-to-date saleable literature in all the principal vernaculars. Pastor Fletcher's book "The Future of the World," will soon be off the press in several of the leading vernaculars.

In the spirit of prophecy we are told, that "From them [the publishing houses] is to go forth the terrible denunciation 'Babylon is fallen, Babylon is fallen, that great city because she made all nations drink of the wrath of her fornication,' and in a large degree through the medium of our publishing houses is to be accomplished the work of that other angel who comes down from heaven with power, and who lightens the earth with his glory."

Let us each one begin to pray now for the success of the work during this "Big Week." Let us help to answer our prayers by one and all—superintendents, departmental secretaries, station workers, students and evangelists going to the people with the printed page.

Yours for a "BIG WEEK,"

L. C. SHEPARD, *Field Sec'y*,
S. A. Division, General
Conference of S. D. A.

Summary of Colporteur Work in Southern Asia for the Months of June and July, 1920.

JUNE	No. of Colporteurs	Hours	Sales
North-east India.....	12	2,002	Rs. 168-11-6
North-west India.....	4	0	69- 4-0
South India.....	13	963	215- 1-6
Burma.....	1	15	60- 5-6
English.....	1	185	616- 6-0
Total.....	31	3165	Rs. 1159-12-6

JULY	No. of Colporteurs	Hours	Sales
North-east India.....	11	2,071	Rs. 169-10-0
North-west India.....	4	0	78-14-0
South India.....	14	673	236- 6 0
English.....	1	210	517- 5-9
Total.....	30	2964	Rs. 1002- 2-9

THE report for July shows a slight loss when compared to June. There are excellent prospects, however, that there will be a good gain in August.

L. C. SHEPARD, *Field Sec'y*.

BROTHER SAYA BA and family, accompanied by Maung Ba E and wife, have recently arrived in Lucknow from Burma and have connected with our publishing work. Brother Saya Ba is doing translating work and proof-reading while Maung Ba E, an experienced printer, is engaged in the factory as a compositor. We are glad that it is possible for us to enter upon the work of producing literature in the Burmese language in this practical way, and, with the blessing of God, it is hoped that a large supply of our message-filled publications will soon be available for distribution among the Burmans.

Educational Report of Southern Asia Division of the General Conference for the Second Quarter, 1920

	No. Teachers	Boys	Girls
SOUTH INDIA UNION MISSION—			
South India Boys' Training School	5	35	0
South India Girls' Training School	4	0	17
Nazareth Boarding School	8	45	31
Neyyattinkara Day and Boarding School	6	68	71
Lakaweram	2	36	20
Total	25	185	142
NORTH-EAST INDIA UNION MISSION—			
Ranchi Boys' School	4	80	0
Calcutta Girls' School	3	0	40
Sonagram, East Bengal	1	20	3
Karmatar Boarding School	4	27	15
Total	12	77	58
BURMA UNION MISSION—			
Meiktila Technical School	10	125	26
Home School, A. W. Stevens' home	1	1	3
Kamamaung Karen School	2	24	14
Letpankivin Village School	1	8	5
Total	14	168	47
NORTH-WEST INDIA UNION MISSION—			
Open View Mission School, Garhwal	7	80	0
Hapur Boys' School	4	29	0
Hapur Training School	1	9	0
Lucknow Girls' School	4	0	21
Handy Lane School, Aurangabad	1	14	8
Gangapur Village School	1	16	7
Marathi Boarding School, Kalyan	2	20	4
Marathi Training School, Kalyan	3	11	0
Dhundianwala Village School, Punjab	1	16	0
Bandoke Village School, Punjab	1	12	0
Kalwan Village School, Punjab	1	10	0
Total	26	217	40
English Boarding School, Mussoorie	7	11	9
Grand Total	84	658	296

THE report of the schools for the second quarter of this year is very encouraging. In these boys and girls we see the making of many workers for the cause. We perhaps will not count that all of them by any means will enter the work, but think what an increase this will mean to the meagre force that we have in the field now! There young men and women and children are being trained under teachers that fear God and who make His service the first work of their lives. Already in South India many have gone from the school into the work, and in other parts of the field many are in training.

More and more our schools are being conducted for our own children. We can count on these young men and women to grow up with the message and have it a part of them. One that has been trained in our schools is better able to comprehend the truth as we have it than one that has had his education in outside schools and then unites with us later in life. We appreciate all the training that other schools can give, but we feel sure that in the school system that has been given to us, we have something that really counts.

We ask an interest in the prayers of the *Tidings* family that we as teachers may know how rightly to conduct the schools under our charge so that they will be the greatest evangelizing agency that it is possible for them to be.

I. F. BLUE, *Educational Sec'y*,
S. A. Division of General
Conference of S. D. A.

Birthday Offerings

IN connection with the above the question was recently raised as to what was the purpose of the Birthday Offering. Was it to be used for Sabbath school expenses, or should it be turned in for missions? Our reply was that Birthday Offerings, so long as we had known them, had gone exclusively into the missions funds.

The instruction of the Sabbath School Department on this subject reads as follows:

"It is the custom in some schools for the members to give 'Birthday Offerings' to missions. The Sabbath following the birthday, the member gives as many pennies (annas) as he is years old. *These may be added to the regular Sabbath offering to missions*, or kept until the close of the quarter, and thus made to swell the amount of the Thirteenth Sabbath Offering." (This also goes for missions.)

We understand that other plans have been followed in some lands, concerning one at least of which we heard, but we believe all will agree in adopting the counsel of the General Conference Sabbath School Department and devoting the Birthday Offerings to the missions funds and taking up special offerings for any local supplies needed.

Sabbath school secretaries will find on the blank sent out to them by their union Sabbath school secretary a question which reads,—"How much of the money for missions was Birthday Offerings?" Will all our Sabbath school secretaries in local Sabbath schools please keep careful account of these Birthday Offerings and report the amount collected thereby at the close of the quarter?

S. A. WELLMAN, *Sec'y*,
Sabbath School Department
of Southern Asia Division.

EASTERN TIDINGS

Organ of the

Southern Asia Division of the General Conference of Seventh-day Adventists

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E. B. JONES, Editor.

Interest at Poona.

SOME little time ago some South Indian Christians at Poona became interested in the truth, and we understand that one or two began to keep the Sabbath. Since Brother and Sister Thrift have located in Poona with the literature depot of the Bombay Presidency Mission, they have been holding studies in their home, the interest has increased, and some others have embraced the message. Brother Thrift writes as follows:

"Yesterday we had a full house for Sabbath school and after meeting. Fifteen were present, all told, including children, and all of these except one are keeping the Sabbath. Among this number we had Brother and Sister Stotesbury, who have been here for a couple of months unknown to us. The other day we accidentally met them while out driving. They are likely to be staying here for three years.

"I had occasion to visit the Director of the Office of Military Accounts in behalf of the men you met here, and since then we can truly say that God has been working in behalf of those who are endeavouring to serve Him. During my interview on Monday morning it seemed as though the men would receive no concession at all; but before I left he promised to reinstate the young man who had been dismissed, and granted all three Sabbath exemption with the loss of pay for that day. When I asked for exemption for the last two men, the officer asked me how many more did I think would need it. Although I assured him that I could not make a definite statement as to how many would take this stand, he urged me to say how many there might be, so I said, 'There may be ten.' He gave me to understand that should this number or more accept, they would receive the same concession. Seeing the under officer would not allow this young man that had been dismissed to return without a written order from the officer mentioned, I went to see him again on Friday morning. Before the time came for the men to leave the office on Friday afternoon, messages had been sent for the two men to be relieved from duty on the morrow, and all future Sabbaths, and an order issued for the reinstating of the other young man. You can imagine the joy that was expressed as these young men met together in our home at the opening of the Sabbath that evening.

"I am having regular studies with two young men, and two others are starting from the end of the week. In these things we have faith to see the fulfillment of our hope for the early establishment of a church in Poona to represent the cause we love, and to God we ascribe all the praise and glory.

"Tonight I am leaving for Manmad to look up the two colporteurs there."

SISTER G. F. ENOCH has accepted a call from the publishing house for assistance in English editorial work and proof-reading. Sister Enoch will also act as librarian, and will assume her duties in the office during the current month.

PASTOR AND SISTER L. G. MOOKERJEE are at present spending their annual leave at Dingle Cottage, Mussoorie. Pastor Mookerjee was quite ill from an attack of malarial fever as he and Sister Mookerjee passed through Lucknow on their journey to the hills.

WE are glad to be able to state that the latest reports concerning the condition of Sister I. F. Blue and the little daughter, Margaret, are favourable. We understand that Brother Blue has now removed them both from the Mussoorie Hospital to "Grey Castle." During her long illness baby Margaret has been many times near death's door. We join with the parents in giving thanks to God for her restoration.

The School at Garhwal.

THE following report is an extract from a letter recently received by Pastor L. J. Burgess from Brother Peters:

"The work here is going on all right. The number of scholars is increasing day by day. The sum realized in fees is Rs. 70/- each month, and this is collected only from those who can afford to pay.

We are having a fine school this year. The boys as well as the non-Christian teachers take an interest in Bible study. All the older boys study with me. The boys of my class are deeply interested. They have confessed that the Lord Jesus has power to save sinners and that He has answered their prayers occasionally. The Spirit of the Lord is working in the school. I know that you always remember this station in your prayers, but this time I ask you to make it a point to pray especially for these boys."

We trust that the readers of the *Tidings* will remember this request of Brother Peters, that we may soon see fruit of the seed that has been sown in Garhwal.